

Booking Your First Flight

A step-by-step guide to the GDS Trainer terminal simulator

Open `../web/index.html` in a browser to start (or run the `gds-trainer` command-line edition). Everything is typed at the prompt and submitted with **Enter**. Commands aren't case-sensitive, but standard GDS convention is ALL CAPS.

1 Sign in

```
SI
```

Confirms sign-in with a demo agent sine and pseudo city code (PCC). Nothing else works until you're signed in.

2 Search flight availability

Format: A + day + month + origin + destination (or 1 in place of A — both are real GDS entries)

```
A15AUGDFWORD
```

This requests flights from **DFW** (Dallas/Ft Worth) to **ORD** (Chicago O'Hare) on **August 15**. You'll get back a numbered list of flights, each with airline, flight number, seats open per class (F/J/C/Y/B/M), departure/arrival times.

| Any real-world IATA airport code works — the simulator ships with data for ~6,000 airports worldwide.

3 Sell a seat from the list

Format: 0 + line number + class letter + number of seats

```
04Y1
```

Sells **1 seat in Y class from line 4** of the availability display you just pulled up. The simulator confirms the segment and shows your PNR so far (currently just that flight segment).

You can also sell a specific flight directly, without pulling up availability first (a "long sell"). Format: 0 + airline + flight number + class + date + origin/destination + status code + party size:

```
0AA100Y15AUGDFWORDNN1
```

4

Add the passenger's name

Format: – + SURNAME + / + GIVEN NAME + TITLE

```
–SMITH/JOHN MR
```

To add **more than one passenger with the same surname** in a single entry, prefix the surname with a count and chain additional given-name/title pairs with /:

```
–2SMITH/JOHN MR/JANE MRS
```

For passengers with different surnames, add a separate – entry for each. The number of named passengers can't exceed the number of seats sold.

To add a **lap infant** traveling with a passenger, append (INF{SURNAME}/{GIVEN}/{DOB}) to that passenger's name entry (DOB is DDMONYY):

```
–SMITH/JOHN MR( INFSMITH/BABY/12JAN26 )
```

5

Add special service requests / other service info (optional)

Format: 3{SSRCODE} for a service request (meals, wheelchair, etc.), optionally with a passenger number and free text: 3{SSRCODE}–{PAX#}/{TEXT}. Format: 30SI{AIRLINE}{TEXT} for other-service-info free text to a carrier.

```
3VGML
3WCHR–1/AISLE SEAT PREFERRED
30SI AA VIP PASSENGER
```

Common SSR codes: WCHR/WCHS/WCHC (wheelchair), VGML/BBML/CHML/KSML/MOML/DBML/SPML (meals), BLND/DEAF (accessibility), UMNMR (unaccompanied minor), PETC (pet in cabin), BSCT (bassinet), XBAG (extra baggage).

6

Assign a seat (optional)

Format: 4{N} to display the seat map for itinerary segment N, then 4{N}–{SEAT} to assign one.

```
41
41–14A
```

7

Price the itinerary

Format: WP (once segments and at least one name are on the PNR)

WP

Prices the itinerary and shows a base fare, itemized taxes, and total — this is stored on the PNR as a fare quote and is **required before ticketing**. WPNCS prices the lowest fare regardless of seat availability (informational only).

8

Add a contact phone number

Format: 9 + phone number + – + location code (A=Agency, H=Home, B=Business, C/M=Cell, F=Fax, HTL=Hotel)

9214555-1234-A

9

Add "received from" (who the booking request came from)

Format: 6 + text

6JSMITH

10

Add a ticketing arrangement

7TAW/

This means "ticket at will" (no ticketing deadline). There's also 7TAX16AUG/1800 to set a ticketing time limit of Aug 16 at 6:00 PM.

11

Add a form of payment

Format: FPCASH, FPCHECK, or FPCC{TYPE}{CARDNUMBER}/{MMYY} for a credit card (TYPE is VI=Visa, CA=MasterCard, AX=Amex, DC=Diners Club, DS=Discover, JC=JCB).

FPCASH

or

FPCCVI4111111111111111/1225

Just like a real GDS, the PNR can't be saved without a form of payment on file. Card numbers are masked to the last 4 digits once stored.

12 End the transaction (save the booking)

ER

This saves the PNR and gives you a **6-character record locator** — your confirmation code. ER redisplayes the saved PNR; ET saves it and clears the screen for a new booking.

13 Issue the ticket (optional)

TKTT

This is the step people often assume ER already did — it doesn't. Saving a PNR (ER/ET) and **ticketing** it are two different things in a real GDS, exactly like here: the "ticketing arrangement" you added in step 10 just sets a deadline (or "ticket at will"), it doesn't issue anything. TKTT is the actual ticketing entry — it requires the PNR to already be saved (has a record locator) and to have a fare quote, ticketing arrangement, and form of payment on file, and it generates a real-format ticket number (airline numeric code + serial) per passenger, including infants.

If you change the itinerary after ticketing (sell or cancel a segment), the ticket(s) are automatically voided along with the fare quote — you'll need to WP and TKTT again before saving.

14 Look up the booking again later

*ABC123

(using the actual locator you were given)

To see the full chronological history of everything that's been added, changed, or cancelled on the PNR:

*H

Quick reference

STEP	COMMAND	EXAMPLE
Sign in	SI	SI
Search flights	A{DD}{MON}{ORIG}{DEST}	A15AUGDFWORD
Sell from list	0{LINE}{CLASS}{SEATS}	04Y1
Long/direct sell	0{AL}{FLT}{CLASS}{DD}{MON}{ORIG}{DEST} {STATUS}{SEATS}	0AA100Y15AUGDFWORDNN1
Add name	–{SURNAME}/{GIVEN} {TITLE}	–SMITH/JOHN MR
Add multiple passengers	–{N}{SURNAME}/{G1} {T1}/{G2} {T2}	–2SMITH/JOHN MR/JANE MRS
Add lap infant	–... (INF{SURNAME}/{GIVEN}/{DOB})	–SMITH/JOHN MR (INFSMITH/BABY/12JAN26)
Add SSR	3{SSRCODE} [–{PAX#}] [/ {TEXT}]	3VGML
Add OSI	30SI{AL}{TEXT}	30SIAA VIP PASSENGER
Add frequent flyer number	3FQTV{AL}{NUMBER}	3FQTVAA1234567
Seat map / assign seat	4{N} / 4{N}–{SEAT}	41 / 41–14A
Decode airport code	DC{CODE}	DCORD
Search airports by name	DAN{TEXT}	DANCHICAGO
Price itinerary	WP	WP
Add phone	9{NUMBER}–{LOC}	9214555–1234–A
Add received-from	6{TEXT}	6JSMITH
Add ticketing	7TAW/	7TAW/
Add form of payment	FPCASH, FPCHECK, FPCC{TYPE}{NUM}/{MMYY}	FPCASH
Save booking	ER or ET	ER
Issue ticket	TKTT	TKTT
Redisplay PNR	*R or *	*R

STEP	COMMAND	EXAMPLE
Show PNR activity history	*H	*H
Retrieve saved PNR	*{LOCATOR}	*ABC123
Cancel an item	X{N}, X{N}-{M}, X{N},{M}	X2
Cancel entire itinerary	XI	XI
Discard unsaved work	IG	IG
Full command list	HELP	HELP

Full walkthrough, start to finish

```
SI
A15AUGDFWORD
04Y1
-SMITH/JOHN MR
3VGML
41-14A
WP
9214555-1234-A
6JSMITH
7TAW/
FPCASH
ER
TKTT
```

Command & terminology keymap, by PNR stage

Every command and every piece of jargon from this guide, grouped by where it fits in building a PNR from scratch.

STAGE 01

Sign on

COMMAND	DOES
SI	Sign in
SI{sine}/{pcc}	Sign in with a specific agent sine and pseudo city code
S0	Sign out
HELP	Full in-app command reference

TERMINOLOGY

- Sine** — the agent's identifying code, shown on every sign-in and stamped on the PNR's activity log
- PCC** — (Pseudo City Code) the agency/office identifier an agent is signed in under
- GDS** — (Global Distribution System) the reservation platform itself; PNRs, fares, and inventory all live in it

STAGE 02

Shop for availability

COMMAND	DOES
A{DD}-{MON}-{ORG}-{DST}	Air availability
1{DD}-{MON}-{ORG}-{DST}	Air availability (alternate entry, same result)
DC{CODE}	Decode a 3-letter airport/city code
DAN{TEXT}	Search airports/cities by name

TERMINOLOGY

- Availability display** — the numbered list of flights returned by an A/1 entry
- Line number** — the number to the left of each flight on the availability display, used to sell it
- Class of service** — the single-letter fare class (F First, J/C Business, Y/B/M Economy) shown with a seat count per flight
- EQP** — the aircraft equipment code (e.g. 738, 320) shown on each flight line

STAGE 03

Sell the itinerary

COMMAND	DOES
0{LINE}{CLASS}{SEATS}	Sell from an availability line
0{AL}{FLT}{CLASS}{DD}{MON}{ORG}{DST}{STATUS}{SEATS}	Long/direct sell (no availability display needed)
X{N}	Cancel element N
X{N}--{M}, X{N},{M}	Cancel a range or list of elements
XI	Cancel the entire itinerary (all segments)

TERMINOLOGY

Segment — one sold flight on the PNR

Long sell — selling a specific flight directly by airline/flight number, bypassing the availability display

Status code — the two-letter segment status (HK = holds confirmed, the only status a sell in this simulator produces; NN = need/request, used when typing a long-sell entry by hand)

Party size — the number of seats requested in a sell entry; caps how many passenger names the PNR can carry

PNR element — any single numbered line on the PNR display (a name, a segment, a phone, etc.) — what X{N} cancels

STAGE 04

Add passenger data (name field)

COMMAND	DOES
--{SURNAME}/{GIVEN} {TITLE}	Add a name
--{N}{SURNAME}/{G1} {T1}/{G2} {T2}	Add multiple passengers sharing a surname in one entry
--... (INF{SURNAME}/{GIVEN}/{DOB})	Attach a lap infant to the name just added

TERMINOLOGY

Name field — the passenger name(s) on the PNR; required before pricing

Lap infant — an infant traveling on an adult's lap rather than in their own seat; doesn't count against the party size/seats-sold limit

DOB format — DDMONYY, e.g. 12JAN26

STAGE 05 Special service requests / other service info

COMMAND	DOES
3{SSRCODE}[--{PAX#}] [/ {TEXT}]	Add a special service request
30SI{AL}{TEXT}	Add other-service-info free text to a carrier
3FQTV{AL}{NUMBER}	Add a frequent flyer number

TERMINOLOGY

SSR — (Special Service Request) a coded request to the airline: meals, wheelchair assistance, unaccompanied minor, extra baggage, etc.

OSI — (Other Service Info) free-text information sent to a carrier that isn't a coded SSR

FQTV — frequent flyer number, stored as a special kind of SSR

STAGE 06 Seat selection

COMMAND	DOES
4{N}	Display the seat map for segment N
4{N}--{SEAT}	Assign a seat on segment N

TERMINOLOGY

Seat map — the row/column grid of open (.) and occupied (X) seats for a segment

STAGE 07 Price the itinerary

COMMAND	DOES
WP	Price the itinerary
WPNC	Price at the lowest fare, regardless of seat availability (informational only)

TERMINOLOGY

Fare quote — the stored pricing result on the PNR; required before ticketing, and cleared automatically if the itinerary changes afterward

Fare basis — the short code summarizing the fare's class and trip type (e.g. YOW = Y class, one-way)

Base fare — the pre-tax fare amount

Taxes/fees — the itemized government and carrier charges added on top of the base fare

STAGE 08

Add contact & booking info

COMMAND	DOES
9{NUMBER}-{LOC}	Add a phone number
9/{CTY}{NUMBER}-{LOC}	Add a phone number, out-of-area (with city code)
6{TEXT}	Add "received from"

TERMINOLOGY

Phone field — the contact number(s) on the PNR; required before end transaction

Location code — the phone type suffix (A=Agency, H=Home, B=Business, C/M=Cell, F=Fax, HTL=Hotel)

Received From (RF) — who requested the booking; required before end transaction, same as a phone field

STAGE 09

Ticketing arrangement & form of payment

COMMAND	DOES
7TAW/	Ticketing at will (no deadline)
7TAW{DD}{MON}/{HHMM}	Ticketing at will, queued to a date/time
7TAX{DD}{MON}/{HHMM}	Ticketing time limit
FPCASH	Form of payment: cash
FPCHECK	Form of payment: check
FPCC{TYPE}{CARDNUM}/{MMYY}	Form of payment: credit card

TERMINOLOGY

Ticketing arrangement — the deadline (or lack of one) by which the PNR must be ticketed; not the same as ticketing itself

Ticket at will — no fixed ticketing deadline

Time limit — a fixed date/time by which the PNR must be ticketed or it's expected to cancel

Form of payment (FOP) — how the ticket will be paid for; required before end transaction. Card numbers are masked to the last 4 digits once stored

STAGE 10 End transaction

COMMAND	DOES
ER	End transaction, redisplay the saved PNR
ET	End transaction, clear the work area for a new booking
IG	Ignore the PNR (discard unsaved work)

TERMINOLOGY

RLOC — (Record Locator) the 6-character confirmation code assigned the first time a PNR is end-transacted

End transaction — saving the PNR; requires a segment, a name, a fare quote, a phone, a received-from, a form of payment, and a ticketing arrangement all on file

STAGE 11 Ticket issuance

COMMAND	DOES
TKTT	Issue ticket number(s)

TERMINOLOGY

Validating carrier — the airline whose numeric code prefixes the issued ticket number(s); taken from the first segment

Ticketing vs. ticketing arrangement — the arrangement (7TAW/7TAX) only sets a deadline; TKTT is the entry that actually issues ticket numbers, and requires the PNR to already be saved (has an RLOC)

STAGE 12 Retrieve & review

COMMAND	DOES
*R or *	Redisplay the current PNR
*H	Show the PNR's chronological activity history
*{LOCATOR}	Retrieve a saved PNR by its record locator

TERMINOLOGY

Activity log / PNR history — the timestamped, sine-stamped record of every action taken on a PNR, viewed with *H, separate from the record-locator lookup done with *{LOCATOR}